HINDUSTAN INTERNATIONAL SCHOOL
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Karapakkam

HIS GLOBAL CONCLAVE- EDITION 3.0

"Where Young Minds Meet to Debate, Deliberate and Lead."

DISARMAMENT AND INTERNATIONAL SECURITY COMMITTEE (DISEC)

BACKGROUND GUIDE

Agenda:

The Militarization of Artificial Intelligence and Autonomous Weapons

Focus:

Addressing the ethical, legal, and security implications of AI-driven military technologies and autonomous weapons systems.

LETTER TO DELEGATES

Dear Delegates,

We extend our warmest regards to all delegates representing the Disarmament and International Security Committee (DISEC) at the HIS Global Conclave.

As HIS Global Conclave 3.0 brings together future leaders and diplomats, we invite you to engage with one of the most rapidly evolving and complex challenges facing international security today: the militarization of artificial intelligence and the emergence of autonomous weapons systems.

Artificial Intelligence (AI) has become one of the most transformative technologies of the twenty-first century. Its applications span healthcare, education, transportation, and scientific research. However, alongside these benefits, AI is increasingly being incorporated into military operations, raising significant concerns about accountability, ethical decision-making, strategic stability, and compliance with international law.

The development of autonomous weapons systems capable of selecting and engaging targets with varying levels of human intervention has generated considerable debate within the international community. While proponents argue that these technologies may improve military precision and reduce risks

to personnel, critics warn of unintended escalation, civilian casualties, and the potential erosion of meaningful human control over the use of force.

As delegates, you are encouraged to examine the opportunities and risks associated with military AI from both national and global perspectives. You must consider the security interests of your assigned country while also evaluating broader concerns regarding international stability, humanitarian protection, and technological governance.

We encourage you to approach this agenda with thorough research, critical analysis, and diplomatic cooperation. Through meaningful dialogue and negotiation, delegates will have the opportunity to shape recommendations that address emerging technologies while preserving international peace and security.

The Executive Board looks forward to the ideas, research, and commitment each delegate will bring to the committee.

Sincerely,

Chairperson & Vice Chairperson
DISEC

HISTORY OF THE COMMITTEE

DISEC – The Disarmament and International Security Committee

The Disarmament and International Security Committee (DISEC) is the First Committee of the United Nations General Assembly. Established in 1945 under the United Nations Charter, DISEC serves as the primary forum for addressing issues related to international peace and security, arms control, disarmament, and emerging threats to global stability.

The committee examines principles governing disarmament and international security, considers challenges arising from weapons development, and promotes measures aimed at reducing conflict and strengthening international cooperation. While DISEC's resolutions are not legally binding, they often influence global discussions, international agreements, and the work of other UN bodies.

Historically, DISEC has addressed concerns related to nuclear weapons, chemical and biological weapons, conventional arms control, space security, cyber warfare, and terrorism. Through debates and resolutions, the committee has contributed to the creation of important international frameworks such as

the Treaty on the Non-Proliferation of Nuclear Weapons (NPT), the Chemical Weapons Convention (CWC), and initiatives aimed at reducing illicit arms trafficking.

In recent years, technological advancements have introduced new security challenges. Artificial intelligence, cyber capabilities, autonomous systems, and emerging military technologies have transformed modern warfare. Unlike traditional weapons, these technologies often evolve faster than international legal and regulatory frameworks.

The increasing integration of AI into military decision-making has therefore become a critical area of concern for DISEC. As nations race to develop advanced defense systems, the international community faces the challenge of ensuring that technological innovation does not undermine global peace, human rights, or humanitarian principles.

Today, DISEC remains an essential platform for discussing how emerging technologies should be governed to prevent instability, promote transparency, and maintain international security.

INTRODUCTION TO THE AGENDA

Agenda:

The Militarization of Artificial Intelligence and Autonomous Weapons

Addressing the Ethical, Legal, and Security Implications of AI-Driven Military Technologies

Artificial Intelligence is increasingly reshaping military capabilities across the world. Governments are investing heavily in AI-powered systems that can process vast quantities of information, enhance surveillance, improve logistics, and support military decision-making. These developments have the potential to improve operational effectiveness and national defense capabilities.

One of the most controversial aspects of military AI is the development of Autonomous Weapons Systems (AWS), often referred to as "killer robots." These systems are designed to identify, track, and engage targets with varying degrees of human oversight. While fully autonomous weapons remain limited, rapid technological advancements suggest that their deployment may become increasingly feasible.

Supporters of autonomous systems argue that these technologies may reduce human error, improve precision targeting, and minimize risks to military

personnel. AI may also enable faster responses in rapidly evolving combat environments.

However, significant concerns persist regarding their use. Questions remain about who should be held accountable when autonomous weapons cause unintended harm. Critics argue that machines lack human judgement, empathy, and ethical reasoning, making them unsuitable for life-and-death decisions.

Furthermore, the absence of internationally accepted regulations raises concerns about a global AI arms race. Nations may feel compelled to develop increasingly advanced systems in response to the military capabilities of rival states. Such competition could increase instability, accelerate conflicts, and complicate diplomatic efforts to maintain peace.

The issue also intersects with international humanitarian law. Principles such as distinction, proportionality, and military necessity require combatants to differentiate between military and civilian targets and minimize civilian harm. Whether autonomous systems can consistently comply with these principles remains a subject of intense debate.

The international community therefore faces a crucial challenge: how to harness technological innovation while ensuring that the development and deployment of AI-powered military systems remain consistent with international law, humanitarian values, and global security interests.

Delegates are invited to consider regulatory frameworks, confidence-building measures, accountability mechanisms, and international cooperation strategies that can help address the risks associated with military AI and autonomous weapons.

KEY TREATIES AND ACHIEVEMENTS

1. Convention on Certain Conventional Weapons (CCW)

The Convention on Certain Conventional Weapons, adopted in 1980, seeks to prohibit or restrict weapons that are considered excessively injurious or that have indiscriminate effects. Discussions concerning autonomous weapons systems are currently taking place under the framework of the CCW through meetings of governmental experts.

The CCW remains the primary international platform for negotiating potential regulations on lethal autonomous weapons systems.

2. Geneva Conventions and Additional Protocols

The Geneva Conventions form the foundation of International Humanitarian Law (IHL). They establish rules designed to protect civilians, prisoners of war, and those no longer participating in hostilities.

Any deployment of AI-driven military systems must comply with the principles of distinction, proportionality, necessity, and precaution contained within these frameworks.

3. Article 36 Weapons Reviews

Article 36 of Additional Protocol I to the Geneva Conventions requires states to determine whether the use of a new weapon would be prohibited by international law.

Many experts argue that autonomous weapons systems should undergo rigorous legal reviews before deployment to ensure compliance with humanitarian obligations.

4. United Nations Group of Governmental Experts (GGE) on LAWS

The Group of Governmental Experts on Lethal Autonomous Weapons Systems (LAWS) was established under the CCW framework to examine emerging issues related to autonomous weapons.

The GGE has facilitated international discussions concerning meaningful human control, accountability, transparency, and ethical considerations.

5. UNESCO Recommendation on the Ethics of Artificial Intelligence

Adopted in 2021, this recommendation provides principles for the ethical design, development, and use of AI technologies.

Although not specifically focused on military applications, it emphasizes transparency, accountability, human rights protection, and responsible governance of AI systems.

6. UN Secretary-General's "New Agenda for Peace"

The New Agenda for Peace highlights the need for stronger governance mechanisms for emerging technologies, including artificial intelligence and autonomous systems.

It encourages international cooperation to address the security risks associated with technological advancements.

7. Global Discussions on Responsible Military AI

Several states and international organizations have proposed voluntary guidelines concerning the responsible use of military AI.

These discussions focus on:

- Human oversight
- Transparency
- Risk reduction
- Accountability
- Compliance with international law

8. International Committee of the Red Cross (ICRC) Initiatives

The ICRC has advocated for legally binding restrictions on autonomous weapons systems that operate without meaningful human control.

Its work has significantly contributed to global discussions on humanitarian implications of AI-powered warfare.

CONCLUSION

As delegates of DISEC, you are entrusted with addressing one of the most consequential security debates of the modern era.

Artificial intelligence possesses the potential to transform military operations in ways that could enhance defense capabilities and improve operational efficiency. At the same time, the deployment of autonomous weapons raises profound questions concerning ethics, accountability, international law, and global stability.

The challenge before the international community is not merely technological but fundamentally political, legal, and humanitarian. Delegates must consider how innovation can be balanced with responsibility, ensuring that emerging technologies do not undermine international peace and security.

As you deliberate, consider whether existing legal frameworks remain sufficient, what level of human control should be preserved, and how nations can cooperate to reduce risks while benefiting from technological progress.

Through informed debate, evidence-based policymaking, and constructive diplomacy, delegates have the opportunity to contribute meaningfully to one of the most important international security discussions of our time.

Best of luck, delegates!

Regards,
The DISEC Executive Board
HIS Global Conclave 3.0